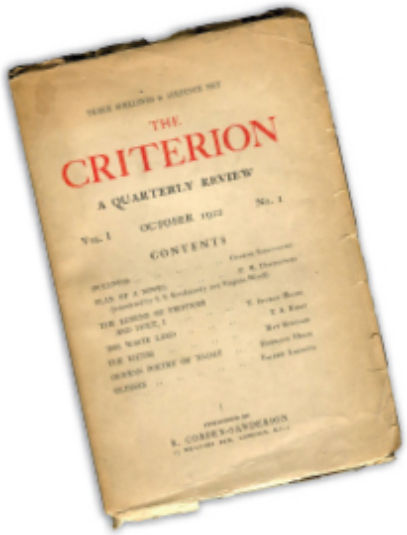
In 1927, Anand worked on the draft of his first novel, *Untouchable*, at Gandhi's ashram. Gandhi read the draft and advised Anand to simplify the language and make it seem more natural. He also advised Anand to travel through rural India and speak to people in order to understand them better.



Anand established connections with several well-known English literary figures, including EM Forster, who would later help Anand get his first novel published. Anand also wrote short reviews and articles for TS Eliot's literary magazine, The Criterion.

A writer and a radical

In 1935, along with other Indian writers and intellectuals, Anand helped found the Progressive Writers' Association. Among their goals was the promotion of a new literature that would address the many forms of prejudice and discrimination that prevailed in India. That same year, *Untouchable*, finally found a publisher after being rejected several times. It memorably depicts a day in the life of a young sweeper and highlights the hypocrisy and cruelty of casteism. In 1936, Anand published *Coolie*, a novel